SIXFOLD COLORADO · BRAND DECISION · 2026-09-25

The tagline, after the reposition

Aeration leads now. The line on the banners, the flyer and the Square invoice was written for fire mitigation, and it does not survive the change — not because it is off-message, but because it is no longer true. Six candidates, a recommendation, and what it costs to swap.

THE VERDICT

Retire it.

~~We do the work and show you who pays for it.~~

Recommended replacement:

From the lawn to the treeline.

Brandon's call, and it belongs in the same sitting as the descriptor — the two live in mostly the same files and sweeping them separately means sweeping twice.

WHY THE CURRENT LINE HAS TO GO

It is a **funding promise**, and it works because of two things that are both fire-specific: the Colorado state tax credit, which covers what a homeowner pays a contractor for **qualifying vegetation work**, and the HB25-1182 insurer re-score, which applies to **wildfire risk**.

Nobody else pays for an aeration. Nobody else pays for mowing, edging or a bed clean-up. On the service that now leads, and on two of the three beside it, the line is not merely off-message — it promises something that does not exist.

⚑ THE DEADLINE NOBODY SET

The line is hardcoded at `brand/square/build-square.mjs:129`, which puts it on the **Square invoice template** and the customer display. **Kara's aeration invoice would go out carrying a promise about who pays for it.**

The rebrand path already names the invoice as the one surface with a real deadline behind it, because an invoice goes to a paying customer with whatever is on it that day. This is that deadline arriving on the copy instead of the mark.

CLEAR / PROTECT / RESTORE — HEARD, AND WHY NOT

Whose it is, stated plainly: these are **Brandon's three circles**. They organised the first three builds of the site-walk sheet, and they are the spine of the 2026 Land & Fire flyer — "*I like the wording and the messaging.*" The frame has real buy-in and it is not being dismissed. Both objections are about the repositioning, not the writing.

1. All three are fire verbs here

CLEAR is fuel reduction. PROTECT is defensible space — the CSFS term verbatim. RESTORE is putting the property back after the clearing. **Aeration is none of the three.** It would tagline an aeration-led brand with a phrase describing every service except the one leading.

2. The sequence is the banned framing

Clear → protect → restore makes restore **the after-job of the clearing**. That is the "landscaping is the after-job of fire mitigation" framing removed from every document in September. It would come back in as the tagline.

It is the same objection as the house on the logo board: **it re-centres the thing being demoted.** What survives is the three-verb spine, which is the part that reads well — candidate 2 keeps it.

THE CANDIDATES — BEST FIRST

	CANDIDATE	FOR	AGAINST
1	From the lawn to the treeline. RECOMMENDED	Spans all four services **without naming one**, so the next change of mix does not date it — and the mix has moved twice in ten days. **"Lawn" is the first word.** It answers the question the logo board already identified as the customer's real one: *will you do my quarter acre, will you do my twenty.* And **"treeline" is the mark's own word** — the conifer is what makes the four peaks read as a treeline rather than mountains, so the copy and the logo would finally say the same thing.	Names no service, so someone who has never heard of Sixfold learns the range but not the work. Needs the service line under it — which every surface already carries.
2	Feed it, clear it, defend it. THE THREE-VERB KEEPER	Keeps **Brandon's three-verb spine**, so his frame survives the reposition instead of being dropped. Lawn first, fire last — the new order, stated. Drops into the same lockups the old line sits in, at the same length.	Names services by implication, so a change of mix still touches it. "Defend" leans fire, just less than "protect" does.

	CANDIDATE	FOR	AGAINST
3	Your ground, all four seasons.	The only candidate that covers **snow** if Brandon takes it, and the only one that says **recurring** — which is what actually changed when lawn care became the business. Pairs directly with the seasonal-palette direction: the words say all year, the palette shows all year.	Says nothing about what is done to the ground. Closest of the six to a slogan rather than a description.
4	Lawn to treeline, all year.	1 and 3 together — the range and the recurrence in one line.	Two ideas is one more than a magnet carries at 40 mph.
5	Aerate · Mow · Clear · Thin	Uses the dot device already in the family — "Slash · Chip · Haul" is on the merch board. Literal, nothing to interpret.	Four service verbs is four things to reprint. It is the "Land & Fire" problem with more words in it.
6	Clear / Protect / Restore KEEP IT	Brandon's, already liked, already printed once.	Describes every service except the one now leading, and the sequence re-creates the framing swept out in September. See above.

If a three-verb line is wanted, it is 2. If the priority is never doing this again, it is 1 or 3.

WHAT CHANGING IT COSTS

Nine files, and the website is not one of them. The site never carried the tagline. `/who-pays/` uses "Who pays for it" as a **page kicker**, which is correct in its own context and should stay.

FILE	WHAT IS THERE
`brand/social/build-social.mjs:40`	the `BIO` const — **one line**, and it regenerates every banner
`brand/square/build-square.mjs:129`	hardcoded in the template — invoice, customer display, online banner
`marketing/facebook-page-copy.md:18`	the page bio
`marketing/square-business-description.md:24`	the business description
`marketing/flyers.html:178`	it is the `<h1>`
`brand/social/README.md` · `UPLOAD-GUIDE.md` · `brand/square/README.md`	documented as fixed copy
`site/README.md:462`	listed under "slogans used, and why each is safe to print"

FILE	WHAT IS THERE
`site/_tabled/merch/`	the "Who pays for it" back tee — off the site, still buildable

The `.build/` HTML files regenerate; they are outputs, not sources. **Do this in the same sweep as the descriptor** — Phase 4 of the rebrand path names sweeping twice for a line that changes again as "the one genuinely wasted week available here."

WHAT THIS DOES NOT DECIDE

OPEN	OWNER	WHY IT TOUCHES THE TAGLINE
The descriptor — retire "Land & Fire", or pick from the six	Brandon	Six candidates written up in `REBRAND-PATH-2026-09.md` §Phase 1. Same sweep, same sitting.
Snow — a service or a favour?	Brandon	If snow is in, candidate 3 gets stronger and candidate 5 becomes wrong on the day it is answered.
Sod — still sold?	Matthew	One line. Does not change the tagline, but it changes the service line printed under it.

FACT-CHECK LOG

CLAIM	STATUS
The current line is the bio line from `marketing/facebook-page-copy.md`	**Read** 2026-09-25; `site/README.md:462` names it as the fact-checked bio line
It is on the Square **invoice** template and customer display	**Read** 2026-09-25 — `build-square.mjs:129`, plus three generated `.build/` invoice and display files
The tax credit covers contractor payment for qualifying vegetation work; HB25-1182 gives an insurer 30 days on a re-score	**Carried over, not re-verified today.** Both verified first-party when `tax-credit-notebook/` was built and audited. The argument here turns only on the scope being vegetation and wildfire
CLEAR / PROTECT / RESTORE are Brandon's three circles	**Read** — `operations/quote-walk-sheet.md`, §"One thing worth raising with Brandon"
They are the spine of the Land & Fire flyer Matthew sent, and he liked the wording	**Read** — `marketing/lawn-infographic-2026-09/README.md`, quoted directly
"Landscaping as the after-job of fire mitigation" is a standing banned framing	**Standing rule**, swept across the repo 2026-09-18
"Treeline" is the mark's own word for the four peaks plus conifer	**Read** — `brand/rebrand-2026-09/README.md`, the fourth objection to the house

CLAIM	STATUS
The website does not carry the tagline	**Grepped** 2026-09-25 — zero hits across the ten page HTMLs; the only match is the `/who-pays/` kicker
Nine files carry it	**Counted** 2026-09-25, excluding generated `.build/` outputs
The mix has moved twice in ten days	**Counted** — descriptor settled 09-16, positioning changed 09-23, landscaping defined as lawn care 09-25

Sixfold LLC — internal decision sheet, 25 September 2026. Draft only: nothing swept, printed, posted, uploaded or ordered. Source of record is `README.md` beside this file. Set in palette A on Bone — green carries every rule and link, ember appears twice and both are warnings.